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Optional Practical Training Extension for STEM Students (STEM OPT)

i ALERT: Please remember that photos submitted to USCIS must be unmounted and unretouched. Unretouched means the photos must not be edited or digitally enhanced. The submission of any mounted or retouched images will delay the processing of your application and may prompt USCIS to require that you appear at an Applicant Support Center to verify your identity.

Certain F-1 students who receive science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) degrees may apply for a 24-month extension of their post-completion optional practical training (OPT).

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Eligibility for the STEM OPT Extension



Applying for a STEM OPT Extension



After Receiving a STEM OPT Extension



STEM OPT Employer Requirements and Responsibilities



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